

AP Human Geography – Political Geography

Examples. The following examples represent different relationships between political and cultural boundaries. With which model (use A-H once each), would you associate each of the following?

1. HUNGARIANS

The state of Hungary emerged out of the Austro-Hungarian Empire after World War I, but with a very restrictive set of boundaries. Although most of the people who live in Hungary are Hungarians, there are Hungarian minorities in surrounding countries, including a pocket of Hungarians in the middle of Romania.

2. U.S.S.R.

The Union of Soviet Socialist Republics was born of the Russian Empire in 1917. It encompassed over 100 different nationalities, 15 of which were assigned Union Republic status. The Soviet Union ceased to exist on December 26, 1991, in part because of the “nationalities problem.”

3. PALESTINIANS

The Palestinians are an Arab people of the Middle East; yet, there is no independent state of Palestine on today’s world political map. The British mandate called Palestine became the state of Israel. Today, the Palestinians people are spread over Israel, Jordan, and Syria, and continue to demand a sovereign state of their own.

4. BRETONS AND BASQUES IN FRANCE

In France, the concept of being French permeates virtually everyone who lives there. Nevertheless, two minorities on the mainland are distinctly non-French, the Basque of the southwest, and the Bretons of the peninsula known as Brittany.

5. ICELANDERS

Although they are of Northern European origin, the people who live on the island of Iceland have evolved as a nation of their own. Virtually the entire population of Iceland is today comprised if Icelanders and few Icelanders live anywhere else in the world.

6. FLEMINGS AND WALLOONS IN BELGIUM

Although the map would encourage us to think that the people who live in Belgium are Belgians, this is not necessarily true. Instead, the people of northern Belgium identify themselves as Flemings, and the people of southern Belgium identify themselves as Walloons.

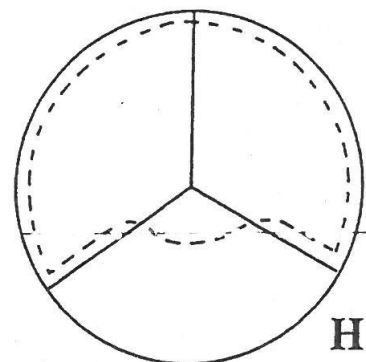
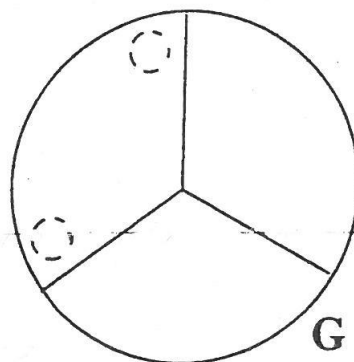
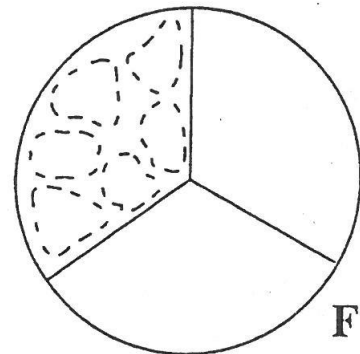
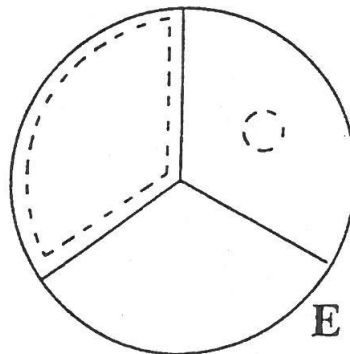
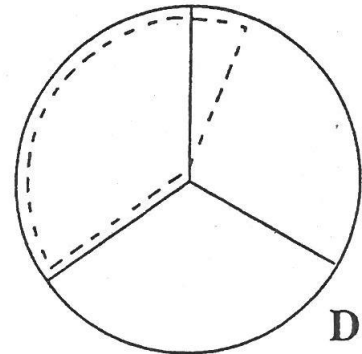
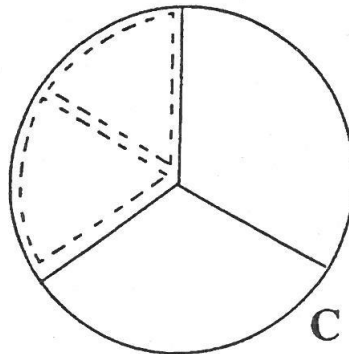
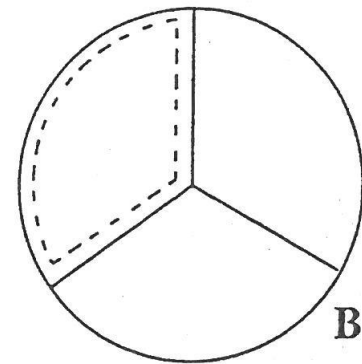
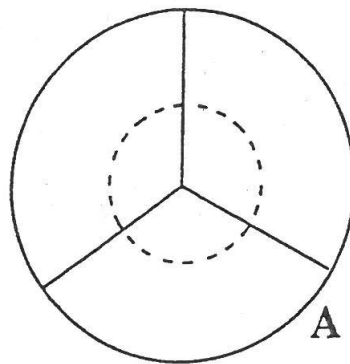
7. GERMANS

There are two German states in Europe, Germany and Austria. In addition about 70 percent of Switzerland’s population is German-speaking, most of whom live on the German and Austria side of Switzerland.

8. ALBANIANS

Most of the people who identify themselves as Albanians live in the Republic of Albania. However, the southernmost part of Yugoslavia, an area bordering Albania known as Kosovo is about 90 percent Albanian.

Geographic Relationships Between States and Nations



— State Boundary
- - - - - Ethno-National Boundary